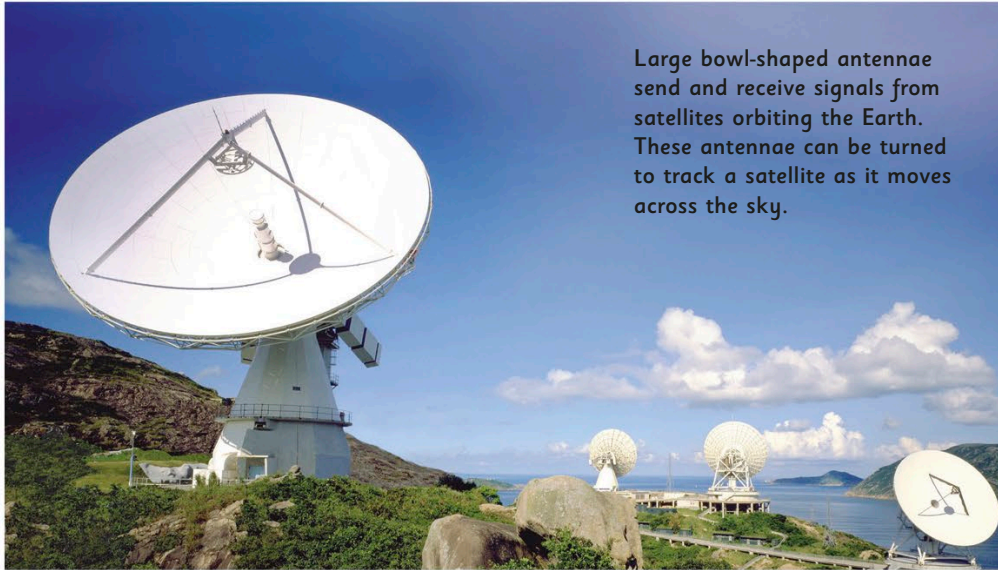




Large bowl-shaped antennae send and receive signals from satellites orbiting the Earth. These antennae can be turned to track a satellite as it moves across the sky.

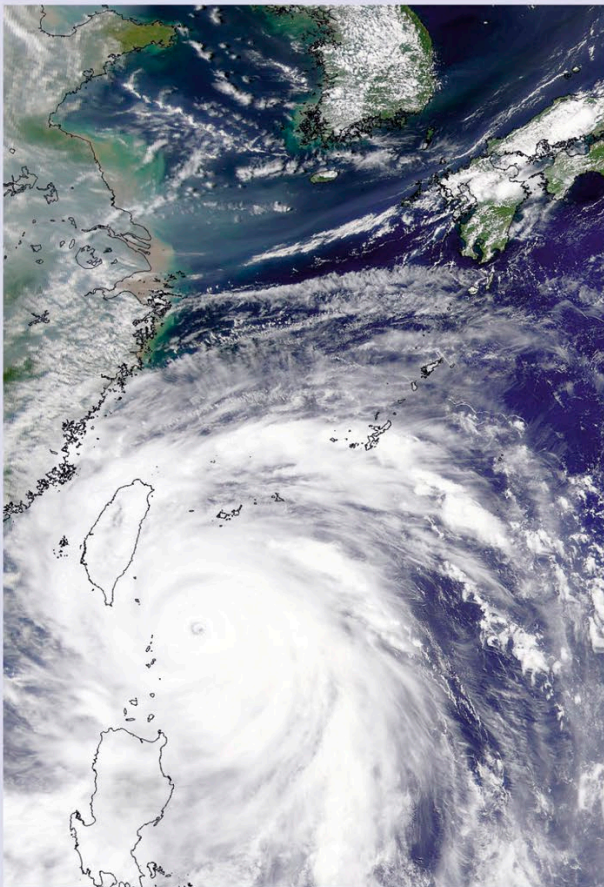
What do they do?

Most artificial satellites are communication satellites, used for things like telephone calls, live television broadcasts, and computer link-ups. Other satellites help with a variety of different jobs, from guiding aeroplanes and ships to weather forecasting.



Charging up

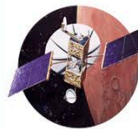
Many satellites have huge solar panels that collect the Sun's rays. These make electricity to recharge on-board batteries that power the satellite.



Weather satellites take pictures of the Earth to show the type and location of clouds, and to measure land and sea temperatures. This is a hurricane moving across the ocean.

Satellite catalogue

There are many different types of satellite.



Communications satellites capture radio signals and send them to different places in the world. They help us to keep in touch.



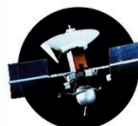
Resource satellites take pictures of natural resources on the Earth. These are sent to scientists, who turn them into maps of things such as oil deposits.



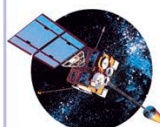
Navigation satellites are used by pilots and sailors to help them work out their location. In case of emergency, they can also pick up distress signals.



Military satellites are used by the armed forces for navigation, communication, and monitoring by taking pictures and intercepting radio waves.



Scientific satellites help experts to study the planets, the Sun, other solar systems, and things like asteroids, comets, and black holes.



Weather satellites help scientists to study weather. Like resource satellites, they have cameras, and they work in a similar way.